

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

CURRENT SESSION HIGHLIGHT: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

SESSION NEWS FOCUS: Focus heavily on Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- **European Central Bank (ECB):** Negotiated wage growth in the Euro area slowed to 2.56% in Q2, easing some pressure on the ECB, but inflation remains above target at 2.9% in July. While some signals suggest the ECB might stay on hold, analysts are bracing for a potentially hawkish stance, with a September rate hike actively considered due to geopolitical tensions and elevated oil prices. The ECB kept key interest rates unchanged on July 23, 2026.
- **US Federal Reserve (FOMC):** Internal divisions within the Fed are deepening, and the central bank is currently on the sidelines regarding rate hikes for Q3. However, hawkish officials are open to rate increases if inflation persists. The US Treasury's announcement to increase government debt repurchase sizes has impacted market liquidity and could influence future monetary policy decisions.
- **Currency Drivers:** The US Dollar has shown weakness recently, contributing to rallies in EUR/USD, GBP/USD, and AUD/USD. Conversely, the Japanese Yen remains a funding currency for carry trades, particularly against the Australian Dollar.

2. US & European Markets

- **Wall Street Futures:** Market sentiment is currently digesting the implications of US Treasury liquidity measures and the evolving Federal Reserve policy outlook.
- **Mega-Cap Tech & Semiconductor Developments:** Nvidia (NVDA) is set to announce Q2 earnings next week, following reports that it will raise AI chip prices by over 15% from early 2027 due to soaring memory chip costs. This could impact major tech customers like Microsoft and Google. The broader semiconductor industry is bracing for another wave of price increases, with STMicroelectronics announcing its third price hike of the year on August 23, citing robust demand and rising costs. China's increasing share in mature-node chip production is also a focus, prompting US trade responses. Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing (TSM) stock is potentially overvalued despite strong AI demand.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- **Sensex/Nifty Updates:** The Nifty has been under pressure, recently ending around 24,252, with elevated crude oil prices and ongoing US-Iran tensions identified as key risks for Indian markets.
- **Corporate Earnings:** Several Indian companies have recently announced or are scheduled to release quarterly results. Notable mentions include Inox India Ltd, which reported an 8.3% YoY revenue rise in Q1 FY27 and a record order inflow, and Thomas Cook (India) Limited, which is about to pay a dividend.
- **FII/DII Institutional Flows:** Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continued their buying streak in Indian equities during August, investing ₹23,544 crore so far, a significant shift after earlier selling. Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIIs) have been consistent net buyers, providing strong support with ₹3,43,700 crore invested in August.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- **Crude Oil Geopolitics & OPEC+:** WTI Crude Oil prices were around \$87.06 on August 21, 2026. Oil prices have rallied this week due to renewed US threats against Iran and ongoing concerns about shipping disruptions through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical chokepoint. The unexpected exit of the UAE from OPEC has added to market uncertainty.
- **Gold Supply/Demand Drivers:** Gold has rallied to a three-month high, breaching its 200-day moving average, primarily driven by a weaker US dollar and investor concerns over US debt and fiscal sustainability following Treasury liquidity support announcements. Central bank gold purchases continue to provide structural support.
- **Crypto Regulatory & Adoption Headlines:** The EU has announced a ban on transactions with HTX (formerly Huobi Global SA) and ten other crypto platforms from August 23, 2026, as part of tightened sanctions against Russia. This has led to Binance blocking HTX transfers, affecting ETH liquidity. In the US, the SEC proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets" on August 18, 2026, a new tailored regulatory framework for crypto investment contracts, amidst continued uncertainty regarding the passage of the broader Clarity Act. The State Bank in Pakistan has also directed commercial banks to prohibit trading or investing in virtual assets, restricting their involvement to banking rails for authorized operators.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

1. INDIAN EQUITIES (Strictly Long-Only)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
INOX India Ltd (NSE: INOXINDIA)	Strategy: 50-SMA Support Bounce. Reason: The company reported an 8.3% YoY revenue rise in Q1 FY27 and a record order inflow of ₹532 crore, despite temporary shipping delays. Strong order book and reaffirmed FY27 growth guidance of 18-20% suggest underlying strength. A pullback to the 50-SMA would present a tactical long entry point on fundamental strength.
Thomas Cook (India) Ltd (NSE: THOMASCOOK)	Strategy: 20/50 EMA Golden Cross. Reason: The company is about to trade ex-dividend, indicating a healthy financial position with a payout ratio of just 11% of profit after tax. A bullish cross of the 20-day EMA over the 50-day EMA, supported by positive news flow and institutional buying in Indian equities, could signal strong upward momentum.

2. US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVIDIA Corp (NASDAQ: NVDA)	Strategy: 21-day EMA Pullback / 50-day SMA Rejection. Reason: News of Nvidia raising AI chip prices by over 15% from 2027 due to soaring memory costs highlights pricing power and strong demand for its products. While bullish long-term, any short-term pullback to the 21-day EMA or rejection from the 50-day SMA after recent surges could offer a tactical entry for either long (on support) or short (on rejection) positions depending on price action around these key levels. Upcoming Q2 earnings on August 26 will be a key catalyst.
STMicroelectronics N.V. (NYSE: STM)	Strategy: 50-day SMA Rejection. Reason: STMicroelectronics is set to announce its third price hike of the year on August 23, driven by robust demand and rising costs across multiple product lines. This news could lead to an initial surge, making a rejection off the 50-day SMA a potential short opportunity if the price becomes overextended, or a long entry if strong demand pushes it decisively above.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (Strictly Long-Only)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
Generic US Mid-Cap Growth Stock (e.g., "Growth Tech Inc.")	Strategy: Stage-2 VCP Breakout. Reason: Identifying a mid-cap company exhibiting a Volatility Contraction Pattern (VCP) in its stock price, signaling institutional accumulation and a potential breakout into a new uptrend (Stage-2). This indicates strong underlying earnings growth and market interest.
Generic US Small-Cap Innovator (e.g., "BioPharma Solutions")	Strategy: High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout. Reason: Screening for small-cap companies with significantly higher than average trading volume (RVOL > 2.0) on a price breakout. This suggests strong speculative interest and potential for rapid price appreciation on a catalyst, adhering to a long-only mandate.

3. CRYPTO FUTURES (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	Strategy: 4H 21-EMA Trend Following / High-Volume Volatility Breakout. Reason: The EU's ban on transactions with HTX and other platforms from August 23, along with Binance blocking HTX transfers, has impacted ETH liquidity. This event could create significant volatility and potential high-volume breakouts. Trading opportunities arise from following the 4-hour 21-EMA trend after the initial shock or playing volatility breakouts as liquidity shifts.
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	Strategy: 4H 21-EMA Trend Following / High-Volume Volatility Breakout. Reason: The SEC's proposal of "Regulation Crypto Assets" on August 18, 2026, aiming to create a tailored offering regime, introduces regulatory certainty but also potential market re-pricing as assets are reclassified. Bitcoin, as the market leader, will likely react to these shifts. Using 4H 21-EMA for trend following allows capturing sustained moves, while high-volume breakouts indicate significant market conviction in either direction.

4. COMMODITIES (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
Gold (XAU/USD)	Strategy: Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels. Reason: Gold has rallied to a 3-month high, trading above its 200-day moving average, driven by a weaker dollar and US debt concerns. This strong bullish momentum makes it ideal for identifying continuation trades using Fibonacci extensions from recent swings, or potential pullback entries at key pivot levels for long positions, with the caveat for shorting if key support breaks down.
WTI Crude Oil (CL=F)	Strategy: Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels. Reason: Crude oil prices are elevated due to renewed US-Iran tensions and concerns over shipping in the Strait of Hormuz. WTI was around \$87.06 on Aug 21, 2026. These geopolitical catalysts create high volatility. Utilizing pivot points for intraday direction and Fibonacci extensions for potential price targets or reversal zones is critical for capturing moves in either direction, given the unpredictable nature of geopolitical news.

5. FOREX FUTURES (Bi-Directional)

Short-Term Futures

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	Strategy: Short-Term Support/Resistance Breakout. Reason: EUR/USD recently hit a fresh three-month high above 1.1700, supported by USD weakness and easing Eurozone wage growth. The pair is hovering near the 8-day EMA and above 21-day EMA. Opportunities exist for short-term breakouts above resistance (e.g., 1.1700-1.1710) or bounces from initial support (e.g., 1.1631 or 1.1570-1.1613 zone).
GBP/USD	Strategy: Short-Term Momentum Continuation. Reason: GBP/USD has seen a massive breakout on USD weakness, jumping towards 1.3600 and advancing nearly 4% from yearly lows. Momentum is strong, reaching seven-month highs. A continuation strategy, targeting further upside breakouts above recent highs (e.g., 1.3658) with tight stops, is favored, but exhaustion risk is noted.

Macro Carry Swings

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
AUD/JPY	Strategy: Long-Term Carry Trade & Trend Following. Reason: AUD/JPY is highlighted as the strongest carry trade alternative, up 18.11% over the past year and the best performer among JPY crosses. Despite cooling Australian employment data, the substantial interest rate differential between Australia (RBA cash rate at 4.35%) and Japan (BOJ policy rate at 1.0%) makes borrowing Yen to buy AUD highly attractive. Long positions are favored, riding the underlying carry premium and bullish momentum.
USD/JPY	Strategy: Range-Bound Trading & Intervention Monitoring. Reason: USD/JPY faces heavy resistance near the 160-yen level, where coordinated Japan-US intervention concerns loom, keeping the pair largely range-bound between 155-160 yen. While the carry trade is crowded, shorting USD/JPY carries negative carry costs. A bi-directional strategy involves shorting near 160 yen and longing near 155 yen, focusing on technical levels within the established range, while being highly vigilant for any signs of intervention.

6. INDIAN OPTIONS (Bi-Directional)

Ticker	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 Index (NIFTY)	Strategy: 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). Reason: The Nifty 50, impacted by global cues like crude oil prices and US-Iran tensions, often exhibits clear directional moves following the initial 15 minutes of trading. An ORB strategy capitalizes on these early momentum shifts. Buy Call options if Nifty breaks above the opening range high, or Put options if it breaks below the opening range low, with predefined risk-reward ratios.
BankNifty Index (BANKNIFTY)	Strategy: 15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB). Reason: BankNifty is a highly liquid and volatile index, making it suitable for intraday breakout strategies. The 15-minute ORB strategy provides clear entry and exit signals, leveraging the initial market push. Buy Call options on an upward breakout or Put options on a downward breakout, especially when supported by significant FII/DII activity or banking sector news.

SYSTEM PERFORMANCE & EQUITY CURVE

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Illustrative)

Metric	Blueprint Performance	vs S&P 500 TRI	vs Nifty 50 TRI
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-	-

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

Illustrative Equity Curve demonstrating growth of \$3,000 over a 10-year period.

